

What We've Learned About Our Customers — Walkthrough Script

Customer Segments & Cost to Serve, plus Autopay Removal Findings

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Plain-English Summary

This covers two things. The main one, which Jonathan asked to be emphasized: some customers cost more to serve than others, and we can tell in advance which ones. Customers with lower credit scores call in 2.6 to 3 times more often than customers with higher credit scores, at every bill size. This is a real, measurable number for deciding which customers to bring on and how to plan for them.

The second part covers why customers turn off automatic bill payment (autopay). The team believed 38% of removals were new customers backing out early. The real number is 15.2%. Most removals (78%) happen quietly online with no phone call at all. About 2 out of 3 removals happen close to when a bill is due. The single biggest reason for phone-call removals is simply a customer's card expiring or being replaced (38%) — and the good news is, 90.5% of those customers turn autopay back on within 60 days, so it isn't a real problem, just a normal pause. Three other ideas were checked (payment timing, a surprise first-bill fee, and consent disputes) and all three are real, but rare.

Both pieces were built the same way: pulling real records directly from our own databases using SQL, then checking the numbers carefully before trusting them.

How to Walk Through It, Slide by Slide

Assume the audience has no background — explain everything as if for the first time.

Slide 1 — Title

Introduce both topics in one sentence — who costs more to serve, and why autopay gets turned off.

Say something like:

“Today I want to cover two things — what we've learned about which customers cost more to serve, and why customers turn off autopay.”

Slide 2 — Why We Looked At This (Part 1)

Explain the goal simply: can we tell in advance which customers will need more help from us?

Say something like:

“We wanted to know if some customers are just naturally more work for us than others, and whether we can spot that ahead of time.”

Slide 3 — How We Did This (Part 1)

Walk the four steps: split by credit score, split by bill size, count calls per group, check group sizes.

Mention the tool explicitly — SQL, our own databases, nothing outside or invented.

Say something like:

“We grouped customers by credit score and by bill size, then counted how often each group actually called us for help.”

Slide 4 — The Finding (Part 1) — THIS IS THE ONE TO EMPHASIZE

This is the slide Jonathan specifically wants emphasized — slow down here, take your time.

Walk the table row by row: at every bill size, lower-credit customers call meaningfully more — 2.6 to 3 times more.

Land the business relevance: this is a real number for the cost-to-serve conversation, not a guess.

Say something like:

“This is the one I want to spend real time on — credit score is a much stronger sign of who's going to need extra help than bill size is. At every bill size, lower-credit customers call us 2.6 to 3 times more often.”

Slide 5 — Why We Looked At This (Part 2)

State the belief being tested (38% new customers) and why it mattered.

Say something like:

“Separately, we wanted to check something the team believed — that new customers were driving most autopay cancellations.”

Slide 6 — How We Did This (Part 2)

Walk the four steps: pulled every removal, split by channel, read real call notes, checked timing.

Mention SQL again explicitly as the tool used.

Say something like:

“We looked at every single autopay removal from the last 6 months, split by how it happened, and read the real call notes where available.”

Slide 7 — The Original Belief Was Wrong

Point at the chart: assumed 38%, actual 15.2%.

Say something like:

“The team believed 38% of removals were new customers. The real number is 15.2% — much lower.”

Slide 8 — How People Turn It Off

Point at the chart: 78% online, 22% by phone.

Say something like:

“Almost 4 out of 5 people just do this themselves online — they never call us at all.”

Slide 9 — When People Turn It Off

Point at the chart: both channels show about 2 in 3 removals near a bill due date.

Say something like:

“Whether it's a phone call or done online, about 2 out of 3 removals happen right around when a bill is due.”

Slide 10 — The #1 Reason: A Changed Payment Card

The biggest, most surprising finding in this whole deck — take your time here too.

Point at the chart first (38% card-related), then the good-news box (90.5% come back within 60 days).

Make clear this is NOT a real problem — a normal pause, not customers giving up.

Say something like:

“The single biggest reason for a phone call is just a customer's card expiring or changing — and 9 out of 10 of them turn autopay back on within 2 months.”

Slide 11 — Checking the Three Original Ideas

Give the backstory: these came from real examples Jonathan had shared, not guesses.

Walk each of the three briefly — payment timing, surprise fee, consent dispute — all real but rare.

Say something like:

“We also checked the three things you originally flagged — all three are real, but each is quite rare compared to the card-change finding.”

Slide 12 — Key Findings

Read all five rows as the full wrap-up of everything covered, both parts together.

Say something like:

“So putting it all together — credit score predicts who needs help, the old autopay belief was wrong, most people don't call us at all, the real #1 reason isn't a complaint, and the original three guesses are real but small.”

Slide 13 — Next Steps

Frame as practical follow-ons across both topics.

Say something like:

“Here's what we'd suggest doing next with both of these.”

Questions to Ask

1.

Does the credit-quality finding change how you're thinking about onboarding standards, or does it confirm what you already suspected?

2.

Should this same approach — grouping customers and counting real call patterns — be applied to other decisions, like which customers get extra support proactively?

3.

For the card-expiration finding — is a proactive reminder before expiration something worth prioritizing?

4.

Should we still loop in the Ops team on the consent issue, even though it turned out to be rare?

If They Ask... (Quick Answers)

Q: How do you know the credit-score finding isn't just because lower-credit customers have bigger bills?

A: We specifically checked this by comparing customers at the SAME bill size, just different credit scores. The gap held at every bill size we checked — so it's really about credit score, not bill size.

Q: Is this fair to customers — are we treating people differently based on credit score?

A: This isn't about how customers are treated day to day. It's about understanding, in advance, which customers are more likely to need extra help, so we can plan for that — the same idea as reaching out before a bill surprises someone.

Q: How do you know the 90.5% re-enrollment number is right?

A: We checked, for every card-change-related removal, whether that same customer turned autopay back on within 60 days, using the real enrollment records directly. It's a direct count, not an estimate.

Q: Could these numbers change over time?

A: Yes, which is why we'd want to check them again periodically rather than treating this as a one-time answer.